

Personal manifesto

Beauty has been such a big part of my life, in ways that have empowered me and handicapped me. The curse of vanity and the social capital that comes with beauty, is a double edged sword. As women we are often reduced to the value of our carnal shell. Some women find power in it and others are enslaved to it, but all are judged on these lines. I don't mean to make this a sob story, on the contrary, I think it's ironic and almost peculiar. Being aware of this gaze gives us the ability to weaponise it. And there's no shame in it. My oldest memories of my mother have almost all been related to beauty and self care. Her filling in her eyebrows everyday before dad came home from work and saying it's important to feel good and look good for your husband even if it's been a decade of being together and he sees me every morning bloated and puffy. Or feeding me paaya (bone marrow) soup saying it's important for long hair and strong nails. Whispering trade secrets about nose contouring and dunking your face in a bowl of ice after applying your foundation. And it felt like, the minute you met another woman or girl who you liked and wanted to include in your inner circle or safe space, you would share one of these tips. An insight into the world of beauty. You book a day at the spa together, or you go do your nails together. It's a safe space, a community, and I think that's what I want. To be a girls girl, to let you in on things that might seem unattainable from the outside. For us to have each others backs. A space where you can be what you want without judgement. Even If that means to reject all conventional notions of beauty or even subscribe to it. I see your insecurities, I've had them. I've just had great guidance and insight, and I want to share that. For years I've been criticised for being plastic, overly sexualised, playing into the male gaze, or that my glamour might stop people from taking me seriously. But honestly? I dont care. It's tiring. I am happy to be an open book, in a space that is devoid of judgement. I don't want to seem elusive or unattainable, I'm happy to let u in on it all. To tell you that fillers suck and never do it; to tell u where I got my nose done and what type of procedure it was, to stop you from listening to all those reels that have said I've got a million more things done than I actually have incase u fall for it and try something you shouldn't. And instead let you in on everything I know. A safe and honest space. For my girls, for my community. I don't take myself too seriously, or any of this really. I know how men see me, and girls too, and yeah maybe I play into it, but it's fun. So it's fine. Do things really need to be that deep? I know what beauty means to me, and in no way do I advocate for a woman's identity to be reduced to how she looks. But let a woman live. We have a multitude of things to offer, but why is it always so hard to compute when a woman enjoys beauty, vanity and self care and she also has an opinion? Has something to say that made isn't as likeable as the clot of her lipstick? Why does it irk so many people when a woman spills outside of the box that society puts you in based on, predominantly, how you look or how you dont. Why can you only be one thing or another? A large part of pampering yourself is feeling good and feeling as though you've done something today and everyday that is good for your mind and body. And it's alright if that means to try to look a certain way. It isn't a burden, because we can set the rules. We just need to allow ourselves to listen to what we want to be, to give ourselves that safe space to figure it out. There's a heaviness attached to makeup, an aspiration for perfection, and then a heavier judgement when you try to attain it. An anxiety about getting your eyeliner right or dabbing the sweat of your nose when you're out. The space I want to create is void of judgement; for people in that headspace and for people who reject it fervently. I want it to feel like a hug, and a secret that'll make u feel like someone has your back and knows how u feel and has thought of something just for you, to make you feel the way you've always wanted to. And it isn't just about the shade of your lipstick, it's about the community, it's about how it's good for your skin and body and therefore mind. In the world we live in today, it feels almost frivolous to harp on about beauty standards and self care because these things are enormous luxuries, and sometimes we forget that. How does one exercise social awareness, inclusivity, compassion, while shedding the guilt and judgement that comes with just wanting to look good? I think perhaps in understanding that it isn't as simple as that, it isn't about just wanting to look good. Its about actualising the power you hold, maybe its about using this community that we build, and giving them the chance, platform and encouragement to be more than you've been told you can be. I'm not sure how, and I realise I'm deviating, but it is enormously important to me that this community stands for something beyond just makeup and commerce. I have been in rooms where I've been told to dress a certain way or look a certain way so the attention is on what I say as opposed to how I look, I don't see the

opposite sex worrying about these things. I've been scared to speak up because I know in some occasions the role that I play is simply eye candy. And its heartbreaking every time I see that happen to another girl. Using your voice needs to be exercised, being aware and opinionated and well equipped to defend yourselves and your intellect- needs to be practiced in safer environments. It is a kind of social capital that women in our country have been kept away from deliberately, for a long time. I wonder if what we create can expand into this sphere, where as cool and celebrated as it is to look and feel your best, its just as cool to say what you feel and be informed about whats happening in the world and to have an opinion that you're unafraid to express. I would like the tone of the philosophy to be self aware but still cheeky, so that it can be a statement about how just because a woman is preoccupied with beauty doesn't mean she's unintelligent or hollow. She's empowered. She's in control. She's having fun. She's whatever she wants to be in multitudes.

Core Philosophy:

I believe beauty is power—but only when it's mine to define, own, and share. I want to create a community where beauty feels like sisterhood, not scrutiny. No shame, no judgment—just honesty, fun, care, and control.

In points:

1. I know beauty is a paradox—it can be both an empowering tool and a burdensome expectation.
2. I'm aware of the male gaze—but I reclaim it with humour and control.
3. I believe there's immense power in transparency—from my mother's rituals to my own journey with beauty, I believe in sharing, not gatekeeping.
4. I want to break down the elitism in beauty and make it feel warm, inclusive, and honest.
5. I reject both purity culture and perfection culture—I'm just as comfortable in bare skin as I am in full glam.
6. I refuse to be put in a box—not by how I look, what I wear, or what people assume beauty means to me.
7. I want beauty to feel like a best friend, not a billboard.

I'm deeply aware of how women are judged and perceived. And I refuse to be victimised by it. I believe in employing a sort of playfully rebellious spirit, to challenge the rules. Never with anger or bitterness but with charm and humor. I would like the brand to reflect a similar tone. I have felt every criticism, comment and remark thrown my way deeply, but I've learned to laugh through the weight of it all. That's not weakness—that's how I survive and stay soft. I would hope that what we create offers people the same outlet and sense of confidence to approach things the same way. To find that strength and humor in it all. To be cheeky with it all. I feel fiercely protective of other women. I don't want to just put products on shelves—I want to offer a kind of sisterhood. I don't believe glamour and intellect are opposites. I believe women carry both. As a brand I want us to be a voice for those who are exhausted by perfection, disgusted by hypocrisy, and at peace with contradiction. This is for the women that want to be seen—not studied. Just like I wanted to be understood—not dissected.

It's for the girl who shows up to dinner over dressed in heels, then kicks them off under the table and eats with her hands. I know the rules of beauty, but i want what we create to whisper to all those people out there who feel cornered and lost, "Break the rules—I'll hold your hand through it"

Brand Philosophy

We believe beauty isn't something you chase—it's something you choose. Whether it's a bold lip, bare skin, or something in between, we're here for the women who've been called too much and still showed up for themselves. **I myself wish for products that marry skincare and colour so that I don't have to choose between looking good and feeling good. Colors that can be your armour, but also heal you over time so you don't feel like you're hiding behind anything, instead you're choosing to have fun, to play a part, to tell a story. Imagine using a foundation that seamlessly covers the acne scars you inflicted on yourself as a naive teenager, and after two weeks of regular use- the same product that you once wore to hide your scars; have now healed them. So now when you put on your foundation, it's a choice; it's fun, and finally, it isn't fear. I hope what we advocate is about owning up to who you are and being unafraid to chase who you want to be.** This is a space where glamour and honesty coexist, where trade secrets are shared like heirlooms, and where being seen doesn't mean being judged. Rooted in rituals, raised on rebellion—our beauty is intentional, irreverent, and proudly our own. Not perfect. Not performative. Just powerful, playful, and really whatever you want it to be. For the girls who break the rules and still know how to blend.

Product Concepts

eg: "You used foundation to hide your scars. Ours heals them too."

- ✨ Rice Water Skin Veil Foundation
 - 🍯 Honey + Vitamin C Serum Tint
 - 🖋️ Winged Liner Wand (for ADHD/anxiety control)
 - 🐚 Cooling Shell Spray
 - 🍷 Ghee & Castor Lip Melt
 - 👁️ Lead-free Surma Kajal
 - 🧠 Skin-fidget Blush Balm

Things that work for me :

For skin: rice water, almond oil for under eyes, betroot for lip discolouration, honey for skin, vitamin C for scars, malai and strawberries for skin moisture, avocado for under eyes, ghee for lips, castor oil for eyelashes, cooling setting spray in place of ice post foundation? Surma for eyes without lead. Lactocalime like cooling clay cream that dries in the color of your skin and eradicates irritation and pimples. Turmeric!!- haldi for everything.

Random ideas for packaging, world building:

Mermaid- siren- Pisces- beauty- power- alluring- enchanting

Pearls of wisdom- pearly- timeless- secrets of the ocean

Stress fidgets - anxiety- sisterhood- comfort- security - safety